

● hunt.za:~\$./welcome

UNIVERSITY OF PRETORIA • CS DEPT • JUNE 2026

// SOUTH AFRICA'S UNIVERSAL ACCEPTANCE BUG HUNT

HUNT.ZA

One day. 30–40 of you. Hunting the bug that stops
South African email addresses from working on
South African websites – then building the fix.

// DELIVERED BY TYTO • HOSTED AT UP • IN COLLABORATION WITH

ICANN

ZACR

Registry.Africa

geoTLD.group

UA Group

DNS.Business

Tyto

University of Pretoria

// UNIVERSAL ACCEPTANCE

Every valid address should work everywhere.

The internet was built on a narrow assumption: short Latin domains, ASCII-only email. The world outgrew it. UA is the principle that every domain and inbox – new, long, or in any script – is treated as equal.

THE OLD WORLD

.com only

Short Latin TLDs, ASCII mailboxes. Anything else gets rejected at the form.

THE REAL WORLD

.africa · नाम@डाटा

1,500+ new TLDs and full-Unicode email across every script on Earth.

WHY IT MATTERS

+1 billion

people come online in their own language. UA decides whether the web lets them in.

• hunt.za:~\$ cat the_problem.md

INFO

// THE PROBLEM

It all comes down to four characters.

```
/^[\\w.%+-]+@[\\w.-]+\\. {2,4}$/
```

.africa 6 chars REJECTED

.joburg 6 chars REJECTED

.capetown 8 chars REJECTED

72%

of global email infrastructure
wasn't Universal-Acceptance ready.

ICANN, 2022 • these are real, delegated
TLDs

// 08:30 → 17:00 • ONE DAY

Two phases. One repo. Three prizes.

09:15

The Hunt

Test real platforms.
Log every rejection.

12:30

Lunch

13:30

The Fix

Build a validator
that gets UA right.

16:45

Awards

Code & findings
published to GitHub.

// 09:15 · PHASE 01

THE HUNT

Break things. Document everything.
Find where South Africa's biggest
platforms turn away valid email
addresses.

● `hunt.za:~$ ./hunt --rules`

PHASE 01

// THE HUNT

Find the rejections. Prove them.

Every valid bug needs three things →

01 Website URL `exact page`

02 Screenshot `the rejection`

03 Description `what you tried`

POINTS PER REJECTED TLD

`.co.za/ .web.za/ .net.za/` **50** pts
`.org.za`

`.africa / .joburg / .capetown/` **30** pts
`.durban`

`other UA issues` **15** pts

`×2 critical · ×1.5 weird · ×1.3 banking / gov`

PLAY FAIR

Max 3 bugs per domain. Rate-limit your tools. Judges verify a sample at lunch – fabricated bugs lose points.

Targets pre-assigned: banks, government, e-commerce, telecoms.

// 13:30 · PHASE 02

THE FIX

Now build it right. A production-grade email validator that accepts every valid address – and rejects the junk.

// THE FIX · ONE FILE OR ZIP → ONE FUNCTION → true / false

Expose one function. Return a boolean.

PYTHON

```
def is_valid(email):  
    return "@" in email
```

or validate

TYPESCRIPT

```
export function isValid(  
    email: string): boolean  
  
or validate · validateEmail ·  
is_valid
```

GO

```
func IsValid(email string)  
    bool
```

or Validate

NOT ALLOWED

No web server, stdin, printing, or Go main(). No email-validation / IDNA shortcut libs – idna, email-validator, validator, isemail, tr46.

ALLOWED

General framework / helper libraries. Zips may bundle helpers, tsconfig.json, package.json.

TEST →

Quick Test (500)

then

Run Full Test

The trap: the invalid pool is weighted – say "valid" to everything and you score 44%.

● hunt.za:~\$./prizes

AWARDS

// 16:45 · AWARDS

Three ways to win.

Top Bug Hunters

most validated bugs

Best Validator

highest accuracy

Overall Winner

highest combined score

hunt.za:~\$./start

All code ships to GitHub – then to the ICANN UA Steering Group.